Tutor Do's, Don'ts & Boundaries

The tutor DOES

- Works with ONE group the whole period
- Sits with the group, away from the board
- Takes three-column notes for the presenter
- Gets group members to ask the questions
- Pushes everyone's thinking to Level 2 and 3
- Checks that the presenter really understands
- Tracks participation

The tutor does NOT

- Teaches the answer or does the problem
- Stands at the board next to the presenter
- Works one-on-one with a single student
- Talks more than the students
- Bluffs when they don't know
- Grades papers or does unrelated tasks during tutorials

Guidelines for effective tutorials

Give students time to think.	Silence is okay. If you are talking, students aren't learning.
Put the work on the students.	Instead of "You need a comma here," say "There's a punctuation mark missing between here and here. Can you find it?"
Use their resources.	Cornell notes, textbooks, classmates, and their teachers.
Have them explain the process.	Ask them to write out the steps or solve another problem of the same type.
Be flexible.	There is usually more than one way to solve a problem or learn something.
Be patient.	Encourage them to try a different strategy when the first one doesn't work.
Never bluff.	If you don't know, say so and guide them to the teacher or a resource.
Be present.	Keep absences to a minimum and tell your teacher ahead of time.
Accept coaching.	Act on suggestions from the AVID teacher or site coordinator.
Build trust.	Be positive, fair, and consistent. Never take advantage of a student's trust.
Report regularly.	You are the teacher's eyes and ears on how each student is doing.

Tutors should never

- Write passes for students
- Send students on errands outside the classroom
- Take charge of the class when the teacher is absent
- Drive or transport students
- Give out personal contact information or connect on personal social media
- Keep a student's safety concern secret (always tell the teacher)

Required: If a student shares something about drugs, abuse, or their safety, tell the AVID teacher right away. The AVID teacher is the final authority in the classroom.